07. Listening 1

Holidays_7.1

Listen to Audio 1. Mark each sentence as T (true) or F (false).

1. The woman is married. _____
2. The first plan was to do some water sport. _____
3. The woman is not from Oxford. _____
4. She thinks that a lot people do not know their own town very well. _____
5. If you da a staycation, you're abroad. _____
6. The woman speaks Russian but she's never been to Russia. _____
7. There are no Russian people living in Oxford. _____
8. Peter asked the writer if the samovar was useful. _____
9. The woman was disappointed with her experience. _____
10. Peter was happy with his staycation. _____

07. Listening 1

Holidays_7.2

Listen to Audio 1. Match each given word/phrase 1-10 from the magazine article with a definition A-J.

1. Vague	A who can speak a foreign language very well
2. Row	B reduce or destroy the pleasure of something
3. Tend to	C uncertain, unclear
4. Trips	D be likely to behave in a specific way
5. Blend	E a mixture of different things
6. Fluent	F brought together
7. Gathered	G wanted to know something
8. Recipe	H make a boat move using oars (= poles with flat ends)
9. Was wondering	I excursions
10. Spoil	J instructions to cook a dish

07. Listening 1 Keys

7.1	1T	2T	3T	4T	5F	6F	7F	8F	9F	10T
7.2	1C	2H	3D	4I	5E	6A	7F	8J	9G	10B

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07. Listening 1 Script

Holidays at Home? – Audioscript 1

Last year we had some problems and we decided to spend our summer holidays at home. The plan was to put our holiday off until winter, but eventually we didn't have it at all, so I hope we'll have a proper holiday next summer! Anyway, my husband and I had two weeks to spend in our town, Oxford, in August, for the first time in years.

What could we do? Our two children were with their grandparents at the seaside and our first, vague idea was to relax, read and do some physical exercise. The town, with its surrounding countryside, offers a lot of opportunities to peacefully walk and row, surrounded by nature. Also, we realised that we didn't know our own town very much!

Actually, neither of us is originally from Oxford, but we've been living here for nearly fifteen years and we consider it "ours". However, when friends ask us about local attractions, we need to ask other people to know more… It's a little embarrassing, but I guess it's quite common. When we're on holiday in another city or in another country, we tend to visit as many places as possible, but back home we rarely go and visit any local attractions, as an art gallery or a museum.

One morning Peter, my husband, was reading an article about "staycation", that is a holiday spent at home, in which you do some day trips to see local "touristic" destinations.

We thought it could be a good idea, I mean behaving like tourists in our own town, so he did some Google research to find out the "best things to do in Oxford" … And we immediately found a lot of interesting, unexpected things!

07. Listening 1 Script

The word "staycation" is a blend of "stay" and "vacation" and, as the article read, it can also mean that you do, at home, things which are typical of another country. I am fluent in Russian because I spent two years in Moscow studying at university and graduated in Russian language and literature. I immediately thought to do something "Russian" in Oxford…

Firstly, I bought a Russian magazine and started reading a novel in that language. Secondly, I gathered information on traditional Russian recipes and started… cooking them, or at least I tried. Also, I attended an Orthodox church, where I met some women of the Russian community in Oxford.

I bought a traditional Russian object called samovar, that they use to boil water and make tea. My husband was wondering what we would do with that big item after the end of our "Russian holiday" but he didn't say anything. He didn't want to spoil my staycation. At the end of the second week, I felt a bit more "Russian" and was quite satisfied with my experience. What activities was my husband happily doing in those days? Relaxing, enjoying lavish breakfasts and a lot of sports!